

Health Benefit of Yoga and Gym: A Review

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ABSTRACT

In today's work environment, it's important to have coping mechanisms that are both accessible and affordable for the general public. Although clinical trials have shown that yoga can alleviate stress, it is necessary to conduct further research on how standard gym yoga classes can help functional individuals. We will attempt to demonstrate that the local organization of gyms—including their spatiality and interaction guidelines during training—is just as crucial for exercise compliance as the culturally influenced values that uphold the fitness culture. In particular, gyms must meet customers' expressive needs in addition to the substantial body goals they pursue. They must provide clients with training facilities where they can feel safe, and have a degree of discretion and sober informality, in addition to qualified trainers.

Keywords: *Gym, Yoga, Health, Fitness*

INTRODUCTION

The idea of being healthy and fit has been increasingly gaining popularity worldwide. As people become more conscious about their health, the demand for fitness programs and exercises has risen significantly. According to the survey on physical fitness in [1], two popular exercises are gym workouts and yoga. While both gym and yoga can help improve fitness, there are some differences between them. This research paper will analyze the disparities between gym workouts and yoga, along with their advantages and disadvantages. The gym is a facility where individuals participate in physical activities to build muscle mass, tone their body, and improve their overall fitness. Typically, as shown in [2] gym-goers focus on weightlifting, running on a treadmill, cycling, and other cardiovascular activities. In contrast, yoga is an exercise that unites the body, mind,

and spirit [4]. It involves performing various postures and breathing exercises that enhance flexibility, balance, strength, and relaxation.

The universal aspiration for physical fitness and wellbeing has given rise to various forms of exercise, including popular choices like gym workouts and yoga. The question of which one is superior has been a topic of debate for many years, with differing viewpoints and outlooks [5]. This research paper intends to scrutinize the dissimilarities between gym workouts and yoga, their advantages and disadvantages. Both of these exercises offer advantageous factors that can aid in different types of bodily improvements. As a result, you may feel uncertain about which one to opt for. In this scenario, it is essential to assess your specific requirements. For instance, if you are embarking on a strict weight loss journey,

then pursuing gym workouts would be appropriate for you. Conversely, if you need to concentrate on your internal growth, boost your mental prowess, and enhance the functioning of your glands, then yoga is the way to go. Moreover, yoga yields gradual but consistent outcomes, so it necessitates investing some time to achieve better results from the exercises.

It can be challenging to compare the advantages and disadvantages of gym workouts and yoga since they are intended for different purposes and have been thoughtfully designed. However, the ultimate goal of both is to promote good health and physical fitness [7]. Gym workouts involve rigorous exercise routines that burn calories and improve flexibility in both the body and mind. An ideal gym workout program targets different muscle groups on different days. It is important to note that gym workouts require expert guidance and supervision to ensure proper form and maximum health and fitness benefits. It is not simply about lifting weights. In contrast, yoga [9] was developed by Indian saints as a way to remain in strict meditation for extended periods. They utilized yoga to keep their minds and bodies healthy for spiritual enlightenment and a healthy lifestyle. Yoga also helps in regulating emotions and bringing flexibility to the body, while enhancing focus towards one's goals in life, which many health experts believe is crucial for success. Performing yoga regularly can assist in reducing stress and achieving peace of mind [11]. Therefore, yoga not only burns calories but can also help regulate the mind.

HISTORY

The history of gym and yoga can be traced back to ancient times. Gymnastics, which is considered the precursor to modern-day gym, was developed in ancient Greece as a form of physical training for soldiers. The word gymnasium comes from the Greek

word 'gymnos', which means naked, as ancient Greek athletes would exercise and compete without clothing [15]. Yoga, on the other hand, originated in ancient India and was developed as a spiritual practice to achieve harmony between the mind, body, and soul. The earliest written records of yoga date back to the Vedas, ancient Indian scriptures that were written between 1500 and 1000 BCE [18]. Yoga was initially practiced by sages and ascetics to prepare their bodies and minds for meditation. In the 19th century, physical exercise and fitness became more popular in the Western world, and gymnasiums began to be established. German immigrant, Friedrich Ludwig Jahn, is credited with popularizing gymnastics as a form of exercise in Europe in the early 19th century. In the United States, Dr. Dudley Sargent established the first modern gymnasium in 1861 at Harvard University. Meanwhile, yoga was introduced to the Western world in the late 19th century by Indian yoga gurus such as Swami Vivekananda and Paramahansa Yogananda. Yoga gained popularity in the West in the

20th century, particularly in the 1960s and 1970s [12], as people became more interested in Eastern spiritual practices. Today, both gym and yoga have evolved and become popular forms of physical activity and exercise. While the gym primarily focuses on building strength and muscular endurance through weight lifting and resistance training, yoga emphasizes flexibility, balance, and mindfulness through various postures and breathing techniques. Despite their differences, both gym and yoga aim to promote physical health and well-being.

GYM VS YOGA

Gym and yoga are two popular forms of exercise that are aimed at improving physical fitness and overall health. However, there are some differences between the two. Gym workouts typically

involve lifting weights, using resistance machines, and performing cardiovascular exercises such as running or cycling. They are designed to build muscle mass, increase strength, and improve overall fitness. Gym workouts can be rigorous and require a lot of effort, but they can also provide quick results in terms of building muscle and losing weight [14]. On the other hand, yoga is a form of exercise that focuses on uniting the body, mind, and spirit. It involves performing various postures and breathing exercises that enhance flexibility, balance, strength, and relaxation. Yoga is often practiced to improve mental health and wellbeing, as well as physical health. It can be a slower form of exercise, but it can also be challenging in its own way. When it comes to choosing between gym and yoga, it ultimately depends on individual preferences and goals. Those looking to build muscle and improve overall fitness may prefer the gym, while those looking to improve flexibility and reduce stress may prefer yoga. Both forms of exercise can be beneficial for males and females, but they may have different effects on each individual's body depending on their goals, fitness level, and other factors.

Age Group

The benefits of gym and yoga can vary for different age groups. Here are some factors to consider when comparing gym vs yoga for different age groups:

- For children, physical activity is important for their growth and development. Both gym and yoga can be beneficial, but yoga may be more appropriate as it can help develop balance, flexibility, and coordination. Additionally, yoga can help children learn to manage stress and improve their concentration.

- For young adults, both gym and yoga can help improve overall fitness and reduce stress. Gym workouts may be more appealing to those looking to

build muscle and strength, while yoga may be more suitable for those seeking a more holistic approach to wellness.

- For middle-aged adults, both gym and yoga can help with maintaining muscle mass, increasing flexibility, and improving cardiovascular health. However, it is important to consider any preexisting medical conditions and choose an exercise routine that is safe and appropriate.

- For older adults, yoga can be particularly beneficial as it is low-impact and can help improve balance, reduce joint pain, and promote overall flexibility. However, strength training exercises at the gym can also help maintain muscle mass and bone density.

In summary, both gym and yoga can be beneficial for different age groups, but it is important to consider individual needs and preferences, as well as any preexisting medical conditions, when choosing an exercise routine.

Gender Preferences

- For men, gym workouts may be more appealing as they tend to focus on strength training, muscle building, and gaining mass. Gym workouts typically involve weightlifting, bodybuilding, and cardio exercises that are designed to increase muscle mass and improve overall fitness levels. On the other hand, yoga may be seen as less masculine and may not be as popular among men. However, yoga can still be beneficial for men as it helps with flexibility, balance, and stress reduction.

- For women, yoga may be more popular as it offers a range of benefits such as stress reduction, improved flexibility, and better posture. Additionally, yoga is a low-impact exercise that can be beneficial for women who are pregnant or have injuries. While gym workouts can also be beneficial for women, some may prefer a more holistic

approach to fitness and wellness that yoga offers.

Ultimately, the choice between gym and yoga for different genders may depend on personal preferences, fitness goals, and individual needs.

Need of Equipments

The use of equipment is a major difference between gym and yoga. In a gym, various types of equipment are used to target specific muscle groups and provide resistance for strength training. Examples of gym equipment include dumbbells, barbells, weight machines, and cardio machines like treadmills and ellipticals. On the other hand, yoga is generally practiced without the use of any equipment. As the paper states in [3] the focus in yoga is on using one's own body weight and breath to achieve different postures and movements. However, some yoga practitioners may use props such as blocks, straps, or blankets to assist in certain poses. In summary, while the use of equipment is essential in a gym setting, it is not typically used in a traditional yoga practice.

Supplementation

Gym and yoga are two different types of physical activities that require different types of supplementations. Here's a brief differentiation:

- **Protein:** Both gym and yoga practitioners may benefit from protein supplementation, but the type and amount of protein may differ. Gym-goers who engage in weightlifting and resistance training may benefit from whey protein or other fast-absorbing protein sources to aid in muscle recovery and growth, while yoga practitioners may prefer slower-digesting protein sources like casein or plant-based protein powders to support muscle recovery and maintenance.

- **Creatine:** Creatine is a popular supplement among gym-goers, as it may improve strength and power output during high-intensity workouts. However,

it may not be as beneficial for yoga practitioners, as yoga is generally a lower-intensity activity.

- **BCAAs:** Branched-chain amino acids (BCAAs) are essential amino acids that are important for muscle growth and repair. While both gym and yoga practitioners can benefit from BCAA supplementation, gym-goers who engage in intense weightlifting and resistance training may require higher doses than yoga practitioners who engage in low- to moderate-intensity activity.

- **Magnesium:** Magnesium is important for muscle and nerve function, and supplementing with magnesium may help to reduce muscle cramps and improve sleep quality. Both gym and yoga practitioners may benefit from magnesium supplementation, but gym-goers may require higher doses due to the intense nature of their workouts.

- **Omega-3s:** Omega-3 fatty acids are important for reducing inflammation in the body, which can be beneficial for both gym and yoga practitioners who may experience muscle soreness or joint pain. However, the source of omega-3s may differ, as gym-goers may prefer fish oil supplements while yoga practitioners may prefer plant-based sources like flaxseed oil or chia seeds.

Overall, while there may be some overlap in supplementation between gym and yoga, the type and amount of supplements may differ based on the intensity and nature of the activity.

Accessibility

Gym and yoga are two different types of physical activities that also differ in terms of accessibility. Here are some key differences:

- In terms of physical accessibility, both gym and yoga can be accessible to people of different ages, genders, and physical abilities. However, certain yoga poses may require a higher level of flexibility and mobility, which

may not be achievable for everyone. In contrast, some gym equipment may not be suitable for people with certain physical limitations or injuries.

- In terms of location accessibility, yoga can be more accessible as it can be practiced in a variety of settings, including at home, in a studio, or outdoors. Gym, on the other hand, requires access to a dedicated facility or fitness center, which may not be easily available in all areas.

- In terms of time accessibility, both gym and yoga can be flexible and accommodating to different schedules. Many gyms are open 24/7, while yoga classes are often offered at various times throughout the day. Additionally, online options for both gym workouts and yoga classes have increased accessibility for people with busy schedules or those who prefer to exercise at home.

Overall, while both gym and yoga offer a range of physical and mental benefits, they differ in terms of accessibility. The best option for an individual depends on their personal preferences, physical abilities, and lifestyle factors.

BENEFITS AND DRAWBACKS

Benefits of Gym

The gym offers various benefits to individuals, including the ability to build muscle mass and tone their bodies, which is essential for those seeking to increase their strength and endurance [2]. Additionally, gym workouts can help with weight loss, stress reduction, and overall health improvement. For example, weightlifting has been proven to boost bone density, reduce the risk of osteoporosis, and enhance insulin sensitivity.

Benefits of Yoga

Yoga offers a variety of benefits for the mind, body, and spirit. One of its primary advantages is its ability to reduce stress

and anxiety. The breathing exercises and meditative techniques employed in yoga have been proven to promote relaxation and calm the mind. Furthermore, yoga can enhance flexibility, balance, and strength, which is especially beneficial for those with chronic pain or joint issues. Additionally, yoga has been demonstrated to improve sleep quality, boost the immune system, and reduce blood pressure.

Drawbacks of Gym

One of the main drawbacks of going to the gym is that it can be expensive. Gym memberships, personal trainers, and specialized equipment can all add up quickly, making it difficult for some individuals to afford. Additionally, some people may find the gym intimidating, especially if they are new to exercising. Another drawback of gym workouts is that they can be high-impact, which can be problematic for individuals with joint problems or injuries.

Drawbacks of Yoga

Although yoga is generally safe and beneficial for most individuals, there are some limitations to keep in mind. One of the primary limitations is that it may not offer the same level of muscle-building benefits as gym workouts. Moreover, some individuals may find yoga too slow-paced or uninteresting. Finally, certain yoga poses can be demanding, and beginners may find them challenging to perform, which can be discouraging.

COMBINING GYM WITH YOGA

The practice of combining gym workouts with yoga has become increasingly popular among fitness enthusiasts in recent years. This is because both gym workouts and yoga have unique benefits that complement each other when practiced together. While gym workouts focus on building strength, muscle mass, and cardiovascular fitness, yoga focuses on increasing flexibility, balance, and mindfulness. Research studies have shown that combining gym workouts with yoga can have significant positive effects on overall fitness and well-being. One study conducted in India found that practicing yoga alongside gym workouts led to significant improvements in muscular strength, endurance, flexibility, and body composition. Participants who combined yoga and gym workouts also reported reduced levels of stress and anxiety, improved sleep quality, and increased feelings of well-being. Another study conducted in the United States found that adding yoga to a gym workout routine improved participants' balance, core strength, and flexibility [14]. The study also found that participants who combined yoga with gym workouts had better posture and reduced risk of injury compared to those who solely focused on gym workouts. Combining gym workouts with yoga can also be beneficial for athletes looking to improve their performance. Yoga can help athletes increase their range of motion, prevent injuries, and improve mental focus and concentration [10]. A study conducted on professional football players found that practicing yoga improved their agility, balance, and power. In addition to physical benefits, combining gym workouts with yoga can also have positive effects on

mental health. Yoga's focus on mindfulness and relaxation can help reduce stress and anxiety, while gym workouts can improve mood and reduce symptoms of depression. Overall, combining gym workouts with yoga can lead to significant improvements in overall fitness and well-being. By incorporating both practices into a workout routine, individuals can achieve a well-rounded approach to fitness that targets both physical and mental health.

EXERCISES

Gym

Depending on the individual's personal fitness objectives, a variety of activities can be done in a gym. Here are some typical workouts for the gym:

- Squats - One of the most effective exercises for strengthening the lower body, including the hamstrings and glutes, is the squat. To perform a squat, stand with your feet shoulder-width apart, and keep your back straight as you slowly bend your knees, descending as low as possible. Then, rise slowly back to the starting position.

- Bench Press - One of the best exercises for building your chest, shoulders, and triceps is the bench press. Lay on a bench with a barbell over your head. Hands should be somewhat broader than shoulder width apart when you hold the bar. Press the bar back up after lowering it to your chest.

- Deadlifts - The entire body is worked during a deadlift, including the glutes, hamstrings, quadriceps, and lower back. Start by standing with your feet shoulder-width apart in front of a barbell. With both of your hands wider than your shoulders and your palms down, grasp the bar. Straighten your legs, lift the bar, and then stand up with a straight back.

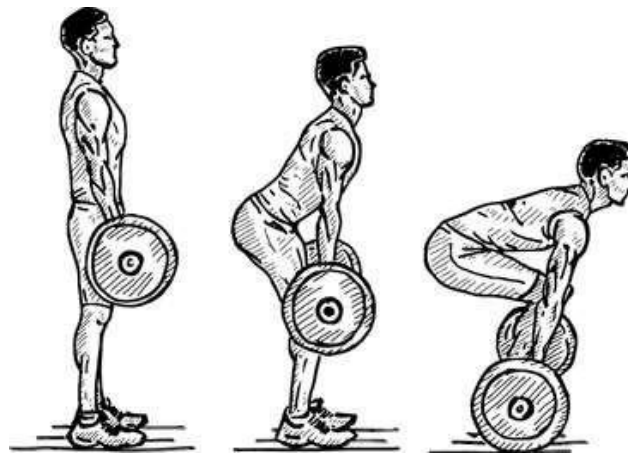


Fig. 1:-Sequence weightlifter doing deadlift exercise

- Rows - Rowing exercises your biceps, shoulders, and back. Grab an iron barbell with your palms facing downward while standing with your feet shoulder-width apart. Lift the barbell up towards your chest while leaning forward, then drop it again.
- Pull-Ups - Pull-ups are a great workout for building upper body strength, especially in the back, shoulders, and biceps. With your palms facing outside and shoulder-width apart, grasp a pull-up bar. When your chin is over the bar, lift your body up and then lower it back down.
- Lunges - Your quadriceps, glutes, and hamstrings, among other lower body muscles, can be strengthened with lunges. Step forward with one leg while maintaining a shoulder-width distance between your feet. Step back up after lowering your body until your front knee is at a 90-degree angle.
- Shoulder Press - Specifically the anterior and medial deltoids are the shoulders that are worked during this exercise.
- Bicep Curls - Biceps are a group of muscles in the front of the upper arms that are worked during this workout.
- Triceps Extensions - The triceps, which are found at the back of the upper arms, are the focus of this workout.
- Planks - This workout focuses on the back and abdominal muscles, which make up the core.
- Cardiovascular exercises - Exercises that help to improve cardiovascular health and burn calories include running, cycling, utilizing an elliptical machine, and stair climbing.

Yoga

There are many yoga exercises, also known as asanas, that target various parts of the body and provide different benefits. Here are a few examples:

- Downward Facing Dog: This asana is great for stretching the entire body, especially the hamstrings and calves. It also helps to relieve stress and improve circulation.



Fig. 2:-Downward dog pose

- Warrior II: This asana helps to strengthen the legs, hips, and core muscles. It also promotes balance and stability.
- Tree Pose: This asana is great for improving balance and strengthening the legs and core muscles. It also helps to calm the mind and reduce stress.
- Child's Pose: This asana is a great way to stretch the lower back and hips. It also helps to calm the mind and reduce stress.
- Cobra Pose: This asana helps to strengthen the back muscles and improve posture. It also helps to stretch the chest and shoulders.
- Bridge Pose: This asana helps to strengthen the glutes and hamstrings. It also helps to stretch the chest and hips.
- Seated Forward Fold: This asana is great for stretching the hamstrings and lower back. It also helps to calm the mind and reduce stress.

CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

Gym and yoga are two popular and effective forms of exercise that offer numerous benefits for physical and mental

health. Gym exercises such as strength training can improve muscle strength, power, and endurance, while yoga practices can enhance flexibility, balance, and stress management. Both gym and yoga exercises are flexible and customizable, making them accessible and versatile forms of exercise that can be tailored to meet individual needs and goals. An increasing number of individuals are interested in combining gym and yoga practices to create a more comprehensive and holistic approach to fitness and overall health. Studies are increasingly exploring the potential benefits of combining these two forms of exercise, such as the effects of yoga on muscle recovery and injury prevention for gym-goers, or the impact of gym training on the physical performance of yoga practitioners. Additionally, new technologies and innovations in the fitness industry, such as virtual reality training and wearable devices, are providing new avenues for exploring the benefits and challenges of gym and yoga exercises.

Further research is needed to explore these emerging areas and develop effective training protocols that maximize the benefits of gym and yoga exercises. To

perform a statistical analysis of gym vs yoga, we can collect data on various aspects related to these two forms of physical activities. Some possible variables to consider are gender, age, frequency, type of exercise. To evaluate if there is a significant difference between the number of male and female participants in the gym and yoga, a chi-square test [19] can be performed. Similarly, a t-test can be used to determine if there is a significant difference between age groups in gym and yoga.

In general, statistical analysis can provide valuable insights into the similarities and differences between gym and yoga and can assist in developing effective fitness programs tailored to the diverse needs of individuals.

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